

TOPIC 1: TYPES AND FEATURES OF NIGERIAN TRADITIONAL ARTS

1. Nigerian Traditional Arts

Traditional arts are art forms produced by Nigerian peoples before and outside formal Western-style art schools. They include sculpture (wood, bronze, terracotta), masking, textiles (Akwete, Adire, Aso-Oke), pottery, body decoration, architecture and performance arts tied to culture and belief.

2. Functions of Nigerian Traditional Arts

- Religious and ritual use (shrines, festivals, initiation)
- Social identity and status (costume, regalia)
- Communication and storytelling
- Decoration and utility (pottery, textiles, furniture)
- Education and transmission of values

3. Importance of Preserving Art as a Cultural Element

Preservation keeps history and identity alive, supports tourism and creativity, and allows future generations to learn from the past. Museums, documentation, apprenticeships and respectful modern use help conserve traditional arts.

4. Summary

Nigerian traditional arts are diverse in form and function. Preserving them protects culture and inspires contemporary creativity.

End of Topic 1